10 Resources to Become Disgustingly Good at Finance

What each resource is, how to use it, when it gets used, and where to find it.

1. MIT OpenCourseWare

Real MIT finance courses, free and open to anyone.

WHAT IT IS

MIT's free library of full course materials, including Sloan finance classes like 15.401 Finance Theory I. You get lecture notes, slides, problem sets with solutions, past exams, and video lectures for many courses, with no sign-up required.

HOW TO USE IT

1. Search OCW for finance courses such as 15.401 Finance Theory I and related Sloan classes.
2. Download the lecture notes and slides, and watch the video lectures where they are available.
3. Work each problem set on your own before checking the posted solutions.
4. Take the past exams under a time limit to see where your understanding breaks down.
5. Rebuild the valuation and portfolio examples in Excel so the theory turns into a skill.

WHEN IT IS USED

Building a rigorous foundation in valuation, risk and return, and capital markets before recruiting or a finance master's.

WHERE TO FIND IT

https://ocw.mit.edu/

2. Wharton Corporate Finance

Wharton's corporate finance fundamentals, at your own pace.

WHAT IT IS

Wharton's Introduction to Corporate Finance on Coursera, taught by Professor Michael Roberts. It covers the time value of money, discounted cash flow, NPV and IRR, capital budgeting, and free cash flow, with a paid certificate option.

HOW TO USE IT

1. Enroll on Coursera and choose the audit option or the certificate track.
2. Watch the weekly lectures on time value of money, discounting, NPV, and IRR.
3. Rebuild every worked example in Excel instead of only watching it.
4. Complete the graded assignments to confirm the concepts actually stuck.
5. Add the certificate to LinkedIn and your resume once you finish.

WHEN IT IS USED

Non-finance majors learning the basics, and anyone who needs DCF and capital budgeting to click before technical interviews.

WHERE TO FIND IT

https://www.coursera.org/learn/wharton-finance

3. Breaking Into Wall Street

Modeling training built around how bankers actually work.

WHAT IT IS

An online training platform for financial modeling, valuation, and interview prep. Paid courses include Excel, three-statement, DCF, and LBO modeling with case studies built on real companies, plus a large library of free articles and guides.

HOW TO USE IT

1. Start with the free articles and guides on accounting, valuation, and LBOs.
2. Pick a core modeling course if you want structured, start-to-finish training.
3. Build each model alongside the videos using the provided Excel files.
4. Work the case studies on your own to practice under realistic conditions.
5. Drill the interview question banks on technicals before first rounds and superdays.

WHEN IT IS USED

IB and PE recruiting prep, technical interview practice, and learning to build three-statement, DCF, and LBO models.

WHERE TO FIND IT

https://breakingintowallstreet.com/

4. Kenji Explains

Excel and finance tutorials that are easy to follow.

WHAT IT IS

A YouTube channel teaching Excel, financial modeling, and finance concepts in short, practical videos. Each tutorial walks through a formula, shortcut, or model step by step so you can follow along in your own file.

HOW TO USE IT

1. Subscribe and browse the playlists for Excel, modeling, and finance concepts.
2. Watch with Excel open and repeat each step in your own workbook.
3. Use the formula videos to learn functions like XLOOKUP, INDEX MATCH, and dynamic arrays.
4. Save the shortcut and formatting tips that make model building faster.
5. Come back to specific videos whenever you get stuck on a task or case study.

WHEN IT IS USED

Getting faster in Excel, learning modeling from scratch, and quick refreshers before an internship starts.

WHERE TO FIND IT

https://www.youtube.com/@KenjiExplains

5. Koyfin

Terminal-style market data in your browser.

WHAT IT IS

A web-based financial data and analytics platform with charts, fundamentals, consensus estimates, screeners, and custom dashboards for stocks, ETFs, and macro data. It has a free tier and paid plans for deeper data.

HOW TO USE IT

1. Create an account and set up a watchlist of the companies you follow.
2. Open a company snapshot to review financials, multiples, and estimates.
3. Use the screener to filter companies by sector, size, growth, and valuation.
4. Build a comps-style table to compare multiples across a peer set.
5. Chart macro data like Treasury yields and spreads to understand the market backdrop.

WHEN IT IS USED

Stock pitches, market updates for interviews, quick comps, and following markets every day.

WHERE TO FIND IT

https://www.koyfin.com/

6. Goldman Sachs Exchanges

How Goldman's leaders and analysts read the market.

WHAT IT IS

Goldman Sachs' podcast, featuring conversations with the firm's leaders, strategists, and outside experts on markets, the economy, and the trends shaping business and investing.

HOW TO USE IT

1. Subscribe in your podcast app or listen on the Goldman Sachs website.
2. Pick episodes tied to the groups and sectors you are recruiting for.
3. Write down one or two key takeaways from each episode.
4. Turn those takeaways into talking points for market questions in interviews.
5. Reference a specific episode to start better conversations on networking calls.

WHEN IT IS USED

Staying current for interviews, forming your own market views, and preparing for networking calls.

WHERE TO FIND IT

https://www.goldmansachs.com/insights/goldman-sachs-exchanges

7. Quartr

Earnings calls, transcripts, and slides in one place.

WHAT IT IS

An investor relations platform with live and recorded earnings calls, transcripts, and investor presentations for public companies worldwide. It has a free app plus paid tiers for more features.

HOW TO USE IT

1. Download the app or use the web version and follow the companies you cover.
2. Listen to the latest earnings call while reading along with the slide deck.
3. Search transcripts for management's exact comments on guidance and KPIs.
4. Compare tone and guidance quarter over quarter to spot what changed.
5. Pull the key points into your stock pitch or model notes.

WHEN IT IS USED

Earnings season, building stock pitches, equity research prep, and following companies closely.

WHERE TO FIND IT

https://quartr.com/

8. Investopedia Simulator

Practice investing with virtual money.

WHAT IT IS

A free stock market simulator where you start with virtual cash and trade stocks, ETFs, and options using real market data. You can join public games or create private ones with friends or a student club.

HOW TO USE IT

1. Create a free account and join a public game or start a private one.
2. Write a short thesis before every trade: why you are buying and what would change your mind.
3. Track your portfolio's performance against the S&P 500.
4. Look up any unfamiliar term in Investopedia's articles as you go.
5. Review your winners and losers each month to learn what worked and why.

WHEN IT IS USED

Learning how markets move, building a track record for stock pitches, and student investing competitions.

WHERE TO FIND IT

https://www.investopedia.com/simulator/

9. Kaggle

Real datasets to practice finance analytics.

WHAT IT IS

A data science platform with free datasets, notebooks, and competitions, including stock prices, company fundamentals, and credit data. It also offers free short courses in Python, Pandas, SQL, and machine learning.

HOW TO USE IT

1. Create a free account and search datasets for topics like stock prices or loan defaults.
2. Take the free Python and Pandas courses if you are new to coding.
3. Copy a public notebook to see how others clean and analyze the data.
4. Build your own project, like a returns backtest or a credit risk model.
5. Publish the notebook and link it on your resume or LinkedIn.

WHEN IT IS USED

Quant and data-heavy roles, fintech, and showing technical skills beyond Excel.

WHERE TO FIND IT

https://www.kaggle.com/

10. Morgan Stanley Thoughts on the Market

Daily market takes in a few minutes.

WHAT IT IS

Morgan Stanley's short podcast with regular takes on markets, economics, and strategy from the firm's research analysts and strategists. Most episodes run only a few minutes.

HOW TO USE IT

1. Subscribe on Apple Podcasts, Spotify, or the Morgan Stanley website.
2. Listen on your commute to build a daily market habit.
3. Note the main call in each episode, like the equity outlook or rates view.
4. Track how those calls change over weeks and months.
5. Use the views to frame your own market opinion in interviews.

WHEN IT IS USED

Daily market prep, "walk me through the markets" interview questions, and building macro awareness.

WHERE TO FIND IT

https://www.morganstanley.com/ideas/thoughts-on-the-market

Want 1-on-1 Coaching to Land Your IB Offer?

Schedule a call directly with Chase to learn about 1-on-1 finance coaching.

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wallstalpha.com/apply